



BUILDING TRUST

Three decades after helping lay the foundations of India's modern stock market, Ashishkumar Chauhan returned to the NSE as its MD & CEO to take it to the next level

BY **ANAND ADHIKARI**



PHOTO BY **MILIND SHELTE**

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HEN ASHISHKUMAR CHAUHAN returned to the National Stock Exchange (NSE) after over two decades, he did not just come back as its MD & CEO. He arrived with an idea and a symbol. At the NSE's Mumbai headquarters stands a towering bull sculpture. Many are familiar with the iconic bull at BSE where Chauhan worked for 13 years before joining NSE in 2022. But NSE's bull carries a deeper message with sculptures of investors, workers, and citizens walking alongside it.

"It reflects something Indian, that markets exist alongside society, not separate from it. Today, it has become part of *samaj*, the society itself," says Chauhan.

There are 128 million unique investors registered on NSE. "Today, 25% of the households have exposure to equities. What was once seen as a niche activity is gradually becoming a mainstream part of everyday financial life," says Chauhan.

As India moves towards its long-term vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047, the exchange's ambition is clear: deepen trust in markets, widen participation, and ensure that capital markets help power entrepreneurship and wealth creation.

Market Infrastructure Institutions

ASHISHKUMAR CHAUHAN

MD & CEO, NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE

Total Income	FY24	16,434
	FY25	21,123
Profit After Tax	FY24	8,205
	FY25	12,059
Net Profit Margin (%)	FY24	49.9
	FY25	57.1

● Figures in ₹ crore; Source: CMIE Prowess